

Abu Bakr as-Siddique bin Abi Quhafah:

During the Lifetime of Prophet ﷺ

1. Abu Bakr was the first adult to accept Islam.
2. Defending the Prophet ﷺ:
 - a. When Uqbah wrapped his cloak around the Prophet ﷺ and Abu Bakr rushed to save him.
3. Calling people to Islam:
 - a. People who accepted Islam via Abu Bakr.
 - b. When the Muslims reached 38 in number, he stood up and called people to Allah and he was beaten so much so that people thought he had had and they weren't able to distinguish between his face and the back of his head.
4. Freeing slaves:
 - a. Bilal ibn ar-Rabiah.
 - b. Amir bin Fuhairah.
 - c. an-Nahdiyyah and her daughter.
 - d. Young female slave of Banu Muammil.
5. Abu Bakr also tried to migrate to Abyssinia but was stopped by Ibn ad-Dughnah on his way and the latter granted his protection.
 - a. When Ibn ad-Dughnah went to Quraish to grant Abu Bakr his protection, the Quraish kept the condition that Abu Bakr would not worship publicly.
 - b. So, Abu Bakr started praying in the courtyard of his house and the people of Quraish would still gather around his house to listen to the Qur'an.
 - c. Quraish complained to Ibn an-Dughnah and when Ibn ad-Dughnah tried to persuade Abu Bakr not to do so, Abu Bakr responded, **"Then I return to you your guarantee of safety and I am satisfied and pleased with the protection of Allah, the Possessor of Might and Majesty."**
6. After the death of Abu Talib, the Prophet ﷺ was looking for a support from an external tribe and Abu Bakr would go along with the Prophet ﷺ as he was knowledgeable of the lineages of the tribes and would help the Prophet ﷺ in this regard.
7. And it was Abu Bakr who was given the virtue of accompanying the Prophet ﷺ on the journey of migration to Madinah and there too Abu Bakr supported the Prophet ﷺ through his wealth and family. He bought camels from his wealth (one of which was purchased by the Prophet ﷺ). From his family and slaves, Asma, Abdullah and Amir bin Fuhairah helped them on their way to Madinah.
8. When the Muslims left Madinah to attack the caravan of Abu Sufyan and the Prophet ﷺ got to know that they will be facing the army of Abu Jahl instead, he took the opinion of his companions. It was Abu Bakr who stood first and expressed his support, setting the tone for others.
 - a. Similarly, when the Prophet ﷺ wanted to inquire about the army of Quraish, he took along with him Abu Bakr.

- b. Also, when a command center was made for the Prophet ﷺ and it was asked that who would volunteer to guard the Prophet ﷺ, it was Abu Bakr who volunteered.
 - c. And it was Abu Bakr who reassured the Prophet ﷺ when the Prophet ﷺ pleaded Allah, saying, "O Prophet of Allah ﷺ, you have sufficiently invoked your Lord, for He will indeed carry out for you that which He has promised you."
 - d. Lastly, when the Prophet ﷺ wanted to take counsel regarding the prisoners of war, he counseled from Abu Bakr and Umar and opted the choice presented by Abu Bakr.
9. In Uhud, Abu Bakr was one of the first ones to reach the Prophet ﷺ after the chaos. He wanted to take out the two rings out of the cheeks of the Prophet ﷺ but Abu Ubaidah insisted and he left it for him to remove.
 10. In Hamra al-Asad, Abu Bakr was there at the forefront to chase the army of Quraish and made sure that the Quraish didn't return.
 11. In the treaty of Hudaibiyyah, ponder over the following hadith:

*"...he (Urwa bin Mas'ood) went to the Prophet (ﷺ) and started talking to him. The Prophet (ﷺ) told him almost the same as he had told Budail. Then `Urwa said, "**O Muhammad ﷺ! Won't you feel any scruple in extirpating your relations? Have you ever heard of anyone amongst the Arabs extirpating his relatives before you? On the other hand, if the reverse should happen, (nobody will aid you, for) by Allah, I do not see (with you) dignified people, but people from various tribes who would run away leaving you alone.**" Hearing that, Abu Bakr abused him and said, "**Do you say we would run and leave the Prophet (ﷺ) alone?**" `Urwa said, "**Who is that man?**" They said, "**He is Abu Bakr.**" `Urwa said to Abu Bakr, "**By Him in Whose Hands my life is, were it not for the favor which you did to me and which I did not compensate, I would retort on you.**"..."*

(Bukhari: 2731-32)

- a. And when Umar was grieved after concluding the articles of treaty, it was Abu Bakr who advised Umar to hold his horses.

*`Umar bin Al-Khattab said, "I went to the Prophet (ﷺ) and said, '**Aren't you truly the Messenger of Allah?**' The Prophet (ﷺ) said, 'Yes, indeed.' I said, '**Isn't our Cause just and the cause of the enemy unjust?**' He said, 'Yes.' I said, '**Then why should we be humble in our religion?**' He said, '**I am Allah's Messenger (ﷺ) and I do not disobey Him, and He will make me victorious.**' I said, '**Didn't you tell us that we would go to the Ka`ba and perform Tawaf around it?**' He said, '**Yes, but did I tell you that we would visit the Ka`ba this year?**' I said, 'No.' He said, '**So you will visit it and perform Tawaf around it?**' "*

*`Umar further said, "I went to Abu Bakr and said, '**O Abu Bakr! Isn't he truly Allah's Prophet?**' He replied, 'Yes.' I said, '**Then why should we be humble in our religion?**' He said, '**Indeed, he is Allah's Messenger (ﷺ) and he does not disobey his Lord, and He will make him victorious. Adhere to him as, by Allah, he is on the right.**' I said, 'Was he not telling us that we would go to the Ka`ba and perform Tawaf around it?' He said, '**Yes, but did he tell you that you would go to the Ka`ba this year?**' I said, 'No.' He said, "**You will go to Ka`ba and perform Tawaf around it.**"*

(Bukhari: 2731-32)

12. When the Prophet ﷺ wanted to conquer Makkah, he ﷺ took advice from Abu Bakr.
13. During the Tabuk expedition, Abu Bakr gave all of his wealth in charity:

Narrated Zaid bin Aslam:

*"I heard 'Umar bin Al-Khattab saying: 'We were ordered by the Messenger of Allah (ﷺ) to give in charity, and that coincided with a time in which I had some wealth, so I said, **"Today I will beat Abu Bakr, if ever I beat him."** So I came with half of my wealth, and the Messenger of Allah (ﷺ) said: **"What did you leave for your family?"** I said: "The like of it." And Abu Bakr came with everything he had, so he said: **"O Abu Bakr! What did you leave for your family?"** He said: **"I left Allah and His Messenger for them."** I said: **"[By Allah] I will never be able to beat him to something."***

(Tirmidhi: 3675)

14. The first time Muslims went to perform hajj, the Prophet ﷺ appointed Abu Bakr as the leader of hujjaj.

Death of the Prophet ﷺ and Abu Bakr's role:

1. Abu Bakr was the one who understood the words of the Prophet ﷺ that the time of his death was near:

Narrated Abu Sa'id Al-Khudri:

*Allah's Messenger (ﷺ) addressed the people saying, **"Allah has given option to a slave to choose this world or what is with Him. The slave has chosen what is with Allah."** Abu Bakr wept, and we were astonished at his weeping caused by what the Prophet (ﷺ) mentioned as to a Slave (of Allah) who had been offered a choice, (we learned later on) that Allah's Messenger (ﷺ) himself was the person who was given the choice, and that Abu Bakr knew best of all of us. Allah's Messenger (ﷺ) added, **"The person who has favored me most of all both with his company and wealth, is Abu Bakr. If I were to take a Khalil other than my Lord, I would have taken Abu Bakr as such, but (what relates us) is the Islamic brotherhood and friendliness. All the gates of the Mosque should be closed except the gate of Abu Bakr."***

2. Abu Bakr was the one who was asked to lead the people in prayer in the absence of Prophet ﷺ

*When the Prophet ﷺ fell ill, he said, **"Order Abu Bakr to lead the people in prayer."***

(Bukhari: 3385)

3. It was Abu Bakr who brought people back to their senses when the Prophet ﷺ had passed away and the people were in a state of disbelief.

Narrated `Aisha:

*Abu Bakr came from his house at As-Sunh on a horse. He dismounted and entered the Mosque, but did not speak to the people till he entered upon `Aisha and went straight to Allah's Messenger (ﷺ) who was covered with Hibra cloth (i.e. a kind of Yemenite cloth). He then uncovered the Prophet's face and bowed over him and kissed him and wept, saying, **"Let my father and mother be sacrificed for you. By Allah, Allah will never cause you to die twice. As for the death which was written for you, has come upon you."** Narrated Ibn*

`Abbas: Abu Bakr went out while `Umar bin Al-Khattab was talking to the people. Abu Bakr said, "Sit down, O `Umar!" But `Umar refused to sit down. So the people came to Abu Bakr and left `Umar. Abu Bakr said, "To proceed, if anyone amongst you used to worship Muhammad, then Muhammad is dead, but if (anyone of) you used to worship Allah, then Allah is Alive and shall never die. Allah said:--"Muhammad is no more than an Apostle, and indeed (many) apostles have passed away before him..(till the end of the Verse).....Allah will reward to those who are thankful." (3.144) By Allah, it was as if the people never knew that Allah had revealed this Verse before till Abu Bakr recited it and all the people received it from him, and I heard everybody reciting it (then). Narrated Az-Zuhri: Sa`id bin Al-Musaiyab told me that `Umar said, "By Allah, when I heard Abu Bakr reciting it, my legs could not support me and I fell down at the very moment of hearing him reciting it, declaring that the Prophet (ﷺ) had died."
(Bukhari: 4452-54)

Indicators of Abu Bakr's Caliphate:

1. There are two major opinions within the Sunni Muslims:
 - a. The Prophet ﷺ explicitly indicated towards the caliphate of Abu Bakr.
 - b. The Prophet ﷺ implicitly indicated towards the caliphate of Abu Bakr (majority opinion).
2. The majority opinion quotes the following narrations:
 - a. Narrated Jubair bin Mut`im:

A woman came to the Prophet (ﷺ) who ordered her to return to him again. She said, "What if I came and did not find you?" as if she wanted to say, "If I found you dead?" The Prophet (ﷺ) said, "If you should not find me, go to Abu Bakr."
(Bukhari: 3659)
 - b. Narrated Ibn `Umar:

Allah's Messenger (ﷺ) said, "(I saw in a dream that) while I was standing at a well and drawing water therefrom, suddenly Abu Bakr and `Umar came to me. Abu Bakr took the bucket and drew one or two buckets (full of water), but there was weakness in his pulling, but Allah forgave him. Then Ibn Al- Khattab took the bucket from Abu Bakr's hand and the bucket turned into a very large one in his hand. I have never seen any strong man among the people doing such a hard job as `Umar did, till (the people drank to their satisfaction) and water their camels to their fill and they sat near the water."
(Bukhari: 7019)
 - c. A'isha reported that Allah's Messenger (ﷺ) in his (last) illness asked me to call Abu Bakr, her father, and her brother too, so that he might write a document, for he feared that someone else might be desirous (of succeeding him) and that some claimant may say:

I have better claim to it, whereas Allah and the Faithful do not substantiate the claim of anyone but that of Abu Bakr.